HARDER QUESTIONS

Seven questions that take longer than a minute.

A free starter set. One question per page, one follow-up that makes it harder, and room to write. No answers are provided, because there aren't any.

WRITTEN BY AN AI · CHOSEN BY A HUMAN

FREE SET · 2026

Each question here fails the one-sentence test on purpose. If an answer comes quickly, it is usually the answer you keep ready for other people. The follow-up under each question is there for that case.

Take one a day, or all seven on a Sunday night. Write in the lines, or don't. The only rule is that you answer in your own words, not in the words you'd use if someone were reading.

Nobody is.

What are you calling patience that is actually avoidance?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

If you named it instantly, how long have you known?

Most people answer this with something they have already decided to do "when the time is right." The time is usually a person, not a date.

Which of your friends would be surprised by how you talk about them when they're not there?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

What does that say about who you perform for?

The surprise usually runs in one of two directions: kinder than they'd expect, or less loyal than they'd expect. Notice which one you reached for first.

What do you tell new people about yourself that hasn't been true for a while?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

When did you last update the story, and what made you stop?

The lines people keep are rarely lies. They are old facts that used to earn something: a laugh, an impression, a shortcut. The question is what you're still buying with them.

What are you good at that you've started to resent?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

Who benefits from you staying good at it?

Resentment of a skill almost always points at a role: the reliable one, the organized one, the one who can handle it. The skill is fine. The role may be the thing you want out of.

Whose approval are you still working for who stopped paying attention years ago?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

What would you do this week if they never had been watching?

Common answers: a parent, a teacher, an ex, a version of a friend group that no longer exists. The audience has usually left. The performance tends to keep going anyway.

What did you decide not to want because it looked unlikely?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

Unlikely according to whom?

People rarely remember deciding this. It shows up later as a thing they "were never really into," said about something they were, in fact, really into.

Which version of you shows up when nobody from your past is watching?

IF YOUR ANSWER CAME FAST

Why does that one need the audience gone?

New city, new job, a trip alone: most people notice they're easier to be around when nobody remembers who they used to be. The follow-up is about what the old audience is holding in place.

That was seven. There are fifty-two.

52 Questions You Can't Answer in a Sentence is the full set: one question per page, three follow-ups instead of one, and a short note on what common answers tend to reveal. Built for a year of Sunday nights, or a long week.

Every question is written by an AI and chosen by a human, who throws out the ones that don't land.

harderquestion.gumroad.com